

Tharaka Pathirannehelage

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- IT professional with infrastructure and systems experience in Active Directory administration, multi-OS support, server operations, and network management, transitioning into a dedicated helpdesk and desktop support role.
- Delivered measurable results in a production environment: 85% first-contact resolution rate, 99% uptime across server infrastructure, and a 15% reduction in critical incident resolution time through structured escalation and vendor coordination.
- Brings infrastructure-level depth to a support role capable of diagnosing issues at the OS, network, and hardware layer, not limited to resetting passwords and closing tickets.
- Committed to continuous professional development, with active hands-on lab work in Active Directory, Azure, and networking running alongside formal certification study.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Enterprise Network Simulation (VLAN, DHCP, Routing)

Cisco Packet Tracer | VLANs | Inter-VLAN Routing | OSPF | STP | LACP

[Blog Post](#)

- Designed and implemented a multi-switch network with VLAN segmentation and inter-VLAN routing
- Configured DHCP services for dynamic IP allocation across multiple subnets
- Implemented link aggregation (LACP) and Rapid PVST for redundancy and loop prevention
- Diagnosed and resolved routing and DHCP issues through CLI-based troubleshooting

Active Directory Lab with Infrastructure Services

Windows Server 2019 | Active Directory | DNS | VMware

[Blog Post](#)

- Deployed and configured Active Directory Domain Services (AD DS) with integrated DNS
- Built a virtualized lab environment using VMware Workstation for domain simulation
- Diagnosed DHCP and DNS misconfigurations affecting client connectivity
- Established a stable domain environment supporting centralized authentication and name resolution

CERTIFICATIONS

- CompTIA A+ (220-1201 / 220-1202)
- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA)
- CompTIA Server+
- Microsoft AZ-900
- Microsoft SC-900

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Operating Systems:** Windows 7/10/11, Windows Server 2016/2019, Ubuntu Linux, Ubuntu Server LTS 22.04
- **Cloud & Identity:** Microsoft Azure, Azure Active Directory, Microsoft 365/O365
- **Security:** RBAC, Group Policy, MFA, security fundamentals
- **Networking:** TCP/IP, LAN/WAN, Wi-Fi infrastructure, DNS, DHCP, VLAN configuration
- **Hardware & Infrastructure:** Desktops, laptops, peripherals (HP, Dell, Lenovo servers), NAS storage (Synology, Asustor, QSAN)
- **Endpoint Management:** Active Directory, Group Policy Objects, SMB file shares
- **Support & ITSM:** Ticketing systems (ServiceNow and equivalents), remote desktop tools, asset tracking and management
- **Collaboration Platforms:** Microsoft Teams, Zoom, Slack, Google Workspace, Jira

- **Monitoring & Backup:** Backup configuration, proactive alerting, system monitoring, and incident response procedures
- **Virtualization:** Desktop virtualization design and deployment, Azure Virtual Desktop, VMware ESXi 6.7/7
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, Bash scripting for task automation and troubleshooting

WORK EXPERIENCE

Systems and Security Engineer, Connex Information Technologies, Nov 2021 - Dec 2022

- Managed end-to-end helpdesk operations through a centralized ticketing system, achieving an 85% first-contact resolution rate and reducing average response time by 15% through structured triage and escalation processes.
- Administered Active Directory for 50+ internal users, including user provisioning, password management, permission structures, and access control, maintaining secure and auditable access across the organization.
- Provided cross-platform technical support across Windows and Ubuntu Linux environments, including SMB share configuration, driver issues, and OS-level troubleshooting; standardized recurring fixes into documented procedures, improving team efficiency by 20%.
- Maintained 99% uptime across Linux and Windows production and test servers through scheduled maintenance, backup implementation, and proactive monitoring with automated alerting, reducing unplanned downtime significantly.
- Administered multi-vendor server and NAS storage infrastructure (HP, Dell, Lenovo servers; Synology, Asustor, QSAN storage), supporting reliable network and Wi-Fi operations across the organization.
- Coordinated resolution of 10+ critical incidents annually with external vendors, applying a structured incident response approach that reduced resolution time by 15% and minimized operational impact.
- Designed and delivered a Desktop Virtualization Proof of Concept from initial scoping to purchase approval within 6 months, demonstrating technical viability and business value to stakeholders.
- Developed IT documentation and delivered end-user training programs that reduced onboarding time by 20% and decreased recurring support tickets by establishing clear self-service guidance.

EDUCATION

Lambton College - *Postgraduate Certificate in DevOps for Cloud Computing*

Rajarata University of Sri Lanka - *BSc. Information Technology*

Plymouth University - *BSc (Hons) Computer Networks*